

I have consistently enjoyed my teaching experiences, and I am most fulfilled in a position that emphasizes my teaching contributions. In addition to my current position as a lecturer at Purdue, I was an instructor of record once as a graduate student at UC San Diego and a teaching assistant 27 times. Alongside my classroom experience, I have participated in teaching certificate programs at both UC San Diego and Purdue and I will be participating in Purdue's Student Pedagogy Advocates (SPA) program in Spring 2025.

Teaching Philosophy

The most prominent belief in my teaching philosophy is that education should be interactive. Students are enrolled in a course with an instructor and classmates, and I believe that students are far happier and learn better when they interact with these resources. I have designed my courses to promote and reinforce this interactivity. For example, I demonstrate the basics of how to solve a problem and then have students work in small groups to solve additional practice problems. In addition to interacting in the classroom, I worked to encourage students to attend office hours and work with each other on problems. One way I approach this was offering makeup attendance credit to students who attended my office hours and took a selfie with me. I created this policy as a method for building attendance flexibility into the course, in addition to promoting office hour attendance (which I was told is sometimes lackluster at Purdue). I had very strong attendance all semester, and many students mentioned positive experiences in my office hours in their end-of-course evaluations. One student even mentioned that they enjoyed my office hours so much that they decided to try attending office hours for other instructors! I would love to continue this policy in future courses; it is very easy to administer on my end, making the benefits far outweigh the costs.

A second guiding belief is that students should have many opportunities to learn and to demonstrate learning. While summative assessments like exams are important because we have to assign grades, they are noisy reflections of students' understanding of the material. One approach to mitigate this noise is by providing lots of assessments. Moving some grading weight onto homework assignments and quizzes gives a better representation of student performance. The cost of this is that students need to keep pace with the material more regularly, and that since there are many assignments there is a lot of grading to do. Based on the end-of-course evaluations I received from Fall 2024, many students liked that the grade weight on homework assignments was high and the exam weight was relatively low. Because of this weighting scheme, however, the assignments were often lengthy and many students also mentioned this during their end-of-course evaluations. Moving forward, I will recalibrate the exact distribution of points and length of assignments in order to improve the efficacy of assignments while also being responsive to student feedback.

The third prominent belief in my teaching philosophy is that student feedback is as integral to my learning as an instructor as my feedback is to their learning as students. When I was teaching as a graduate student, I would remind the students that I was also a student and part of my job was to learn how to teach classes effectively. As a faculty member I can no longer use that exact line, but I continue to mention that as a new faculty member my job involves learning how to teach courses as much as actually teaching them. I was very clear with my students on the first day of class that I was open to any feedback they have for me, and I reinforced this by telling them when I was making changes based on their feedback. For example, during the midterm evaluations many students wrote that they liked when I wrote additional content on the board during lecture, so I began to do more board work as the semester went on. Many students wrote in their end-of-

course evaluations how they appreciated that I actually listened to them, and I will continue being responsive to and communicative about student feedback.

Experiential Learning

In addition to my experience with standard lecture courses, I am privileged to have had opportunities for project-based work with students. While at UC San Diego, I served as a teaching assistant four times for a course in the Rady School of Management called experiments in firms and organizations. The course focused on randomized experiments (A/B testing), and culminated with students designing and conducting their own small-scale pilot studies. My primary task was assisting students on how to transition from idea to implementation of an experiment in the very short period of 10 weeks. While this was challenging, it was always worth it to see how much the students learned during the course of the project. I would be very interested in developing a version of this course for Purdue. I also think there are several pieces of Purdue infrastructure that would make the project run more smoothly than it did at UC San Diego, such as a 16 week semester rather than a 10 week quarter, the level of technical skill among Purdue students, and the ability of the Office of Business Partnerships to help facilitate project creation.

I am also excited to serve as the faculty mentor on a project hosted by the Krenicki Institute in 2025. We are still awaiting word on funding and team selection, but I am very excited about the opportunity to combine my economics research training with my passion for working with students.

Teaching Interests

While my PhD is in economics, one of my primary research areas is decision theory, so I am interested in teaching courses in optimization and statistics more generally. I believe the best fits for current course offerings are Business Statistics, Management Science, and Predictive Analytics; but I am also available to teach other courses if needed. I am also interested in developing new courses, including an experiential learning course on experiments in firms and organizations or masters-level courses in causal inference or time series analysis.